

Brad Friis

Senior B2B Account Executive & Strategic Relationship Specialist

Across 26 years, every account held, every contract renewed, and every customer relationship protected has come down to one thing: **human trust built through genuine understanding and direct execution**. Software tools and technological capabilities only matter when they serve the human beings using them. Having spent a dedicated year mastering modern AI development and full-stack software, I bring a rare combination to an enterprise team: a seasoned account manager who listens first, builds deep client alignment, and uses technical tools strictly to solve real operational problems.

CORE EXECUTION PILLARS

26 Yrs

Continuous client relationship & account management record

0%

Churn

Enterprise account portfolio during 2020 disruption

108 Calls

1-on-1 human diagnostic sessions in lockdown

Modern Toolkit

Full-stack software & AI mastery applied to human enablement

HOW I APPROACH ENTERPRISE ACCOUNT LEADERSHIP

A client does not stay because of a product feature; they stay because they trust the person standing behind the system. My methodology anchors modern technical capability inside a deeply human framework:

01. OBSERVE & LISTEN

Human-First Discovery

Showing up on-site and conducting direct 1-on-1 conversations to understand friction points from the user's perspective before suggesting changes.

02. DEFEND & PROTECT

Relationship Defense

Standing alongside clients during operational disruption, stepping in directly to resolve friction, and turning key skeptics into internal advocates.

03. STRUCTURE & ALIGN

Fair Commercial Value

Aligning contract terms, advance-billed service models, and pricing structures directly with mutual business goals and measurable outcomes.

04. MODERN ENABLEMENT

Practical Tech Capability

Leveraging a deep personal mastery of AI and software tools to streamline workflows, remove daily drag, and empower client teams to succeed.

SELECTED CASE STUDIES: HUMAN COMMITMENT MEETS TECHNICAL MASTERY

Human Empathy Under Pressure · 108 1-on-1 Diagnostic Calls · 0% Churn

Case 01: The Human-First Lockdown Response (2020)

HUMAN VALUE: Active listening (LAER framework) and personal empathy protecting an entire enterprise book through crises.

When market disruption hit in 2020, generic corporate emails were discarded. I personally scheduled and conducted 108 individual 1-on-1 video diagnostic calls with key client leads to understand their immediate human and operational struggles.

During one call, a key stakeholder expressed deep frustration and resistance to the platform. Rather than defending software features, I listened, isolated her exact daily bottlenecks, and restructured her team's workflows on the spot. By the end of the session, she felt genuinely supported and became one of the platform's strongest internal champions.

Outcome: Zero account churn across the enterprise book during a period of global upheaval.

On-Site Engagement · 5-Campus Network · Defection Turned to Expansion

Case 02: Rebuilding Trust on the Ground (Multi-Campus Operations)

HUMAN VALUE: Showing up in person to bridge the gap between software delivery and frontline user enablement.

An enterprise client across five locations was actively planning to cancel their contract and migrate to a competitor. Instead of negotiating remotely, I traveled on-site for five consecutive days, sitting alongside frontline administrators, teachers, and leadership across all five campuses.

The diagnostic revealed that the threat of cancellation was caused by fragmented staff training and a lack of ongoing support—not product deficiencies. I designed an account-wide enablement strategy and returned on-site to deliver hands-on training to leadership and staff.

Outcome: Account saved mid-defection, expanded to a 6th campus location, and upgraded with two new recurring service agreements.

Case 03: The Sabbatical: Investing in Modern AI & Full-Stack Mastery

HYBRID CAPABILITY: Stepping back to master modern AI & software development to directly serve client operations.

Recognizing the massive shift toward artificial intelligence, I intentionally stepped off the career treadmill for 12 months to master full-stack software development, LLM architectures, and multi-agent business automations. I built practical tools including operational BI dashboards for commercial design firms, automated competitive pricing intelligence scrapers, custom market playbook generators, and interactive workflow apps using modern frameworks (Supabase, Vercel, Netlify, Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, Grok, Base44, Sanity).

Outcome: I bring an employer an Account Executive who is not only a proven relationship manager, but someone who understands modern software architecture from the inside out and can teach client teams how to adapt smoothly to new technologies.

26-YEAR CAREER RECORD: RELATIONSHIP CONTINUITY & COMMERCIAL LEADERSHIP

Sabbatical & Technical Mastery

Independent Builder (2025–2026)

Focus: Full-Stack AI & Custom Systems

Spent 12 months mastering modern AI models, database architectures (Supabase), cloud hosting (Vercel/Netlify), and building custom automation tools to help businesses modernize.

Senior Leadership / GM

Enterprise Software Sector (2015–2025)

Focus: Long-Term Relationship Retention

Built deep client trust resulting in 8 consecutive years of flagship renewals (Sancta Maria College) and 0% churn in 2020. Designed 6 new lifecycle revenue lines and renegotiated vendor reseller terms.

Sales & Marketing Manager

99 Corporation (2013–2015)

Focus: Clear Value & Commercial Structure

Established transparent commercial terms (50% upfront deposits, setup fees, scriptwriting charges). Increased total client base by ~70% and income by ~120% (+30% profit per client).

Enterprise Account Manager

Xplore Agency (2009–2013)

Focus: Consultative Strategic Selling

Held HB Chamber of Commerce account personally for 4 years. Secured \$70k enterprise builds (Rembrandt Fine Arts) and converted one-off builds into monthly recurring SEO service lines.

Founder & Systems Architect

MySimpleSiteMan (2006–2009)

Focus: User Enablement & UX Lessons

Invested \$400,000+ in self-serve software. Learned the vital lesson that providing technology without ongoing human enablement and strategic support leads to user stagnation.

Media Sales Executive

Canwest / Radioworks (2003–2006)

Focus: Earned Trust & Account Growth

Held key Harvey Norman account for full tenure through trust and high-touch communication, achieving 10–20% annual growth (peaking at 178% of budget quota).

Business Development

Adplus / Tracta (2001–2003)

Focus: Relationship Continuity

Personally managed flagship Hawke's Bay Tourism account across 3 years. Increased total ad revenue by ~60% and advertiser volume by ~40%, while introducing early digital packages.

Event Director

2000AD (1999)

Focus: Vision & Positioning

Secured national corporate sponsors and TVNZ broadcast alignment for an unbuilt millennium event by building trust around shared vision and strategic positioning.

Initiate a Conversation: Strategic Account Executive & Revenue Leadership

If your business needs a seasoned Account Executive who leads with human empathy, builds unshakeable client relationships, and brings deep practical technical capability to empower client teams, let's connect.

Email: brad@clarityengine.ai

Location: Auckland, New Zealand (Available for Senior B2B SaaS Account Roles)